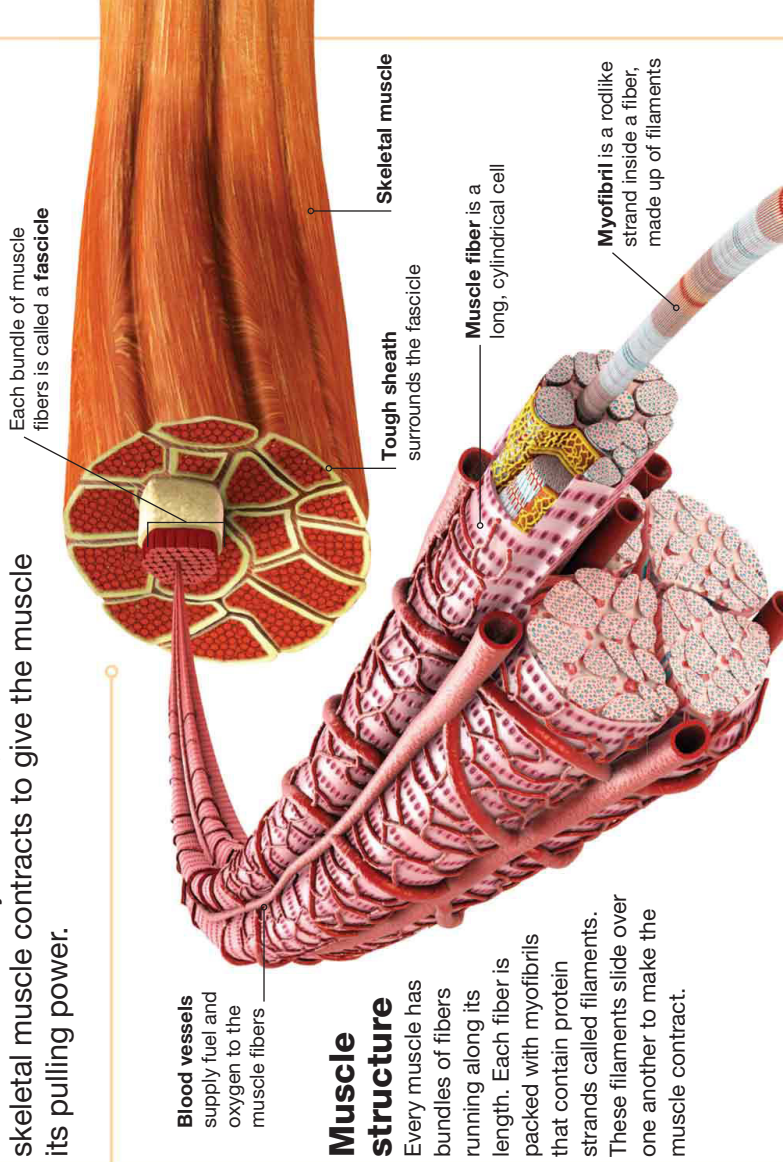


Inside a muscle

Each skeletal muscle has a highly ordered structure, as shown by this “exploded” view. When instructed by the brain, each fiber of a skeletal muscle contracts to give the muscle its pulling power.



Muscle structure

Every muscle has bundles of fibers running along its length. Each fiber is packed with myofibrils that contain protein strands called filaments. These filaments slide over one another to make the muscle contract.